



My foreign language personality

Lesson 1



Agenda

- Introductions
- Quiz: *What's your foreign language personality?*
- Syllabus negotiation



Lektor

About the course

- Focus on English as a lingua franca
- No emphasis on specific English varieties
- English as a global communication tool
- Opportunity to customize through syllabus negotiation



Lektor

All about me in 60 seconds

Think

- Prepare a 60-second presentation about yourself.
- In your presentation, include the following:
 - Name (what you'd like us to call you) and location (where you're based)
 - The first time you needed to use English in real life (outside school)
 - A word or expression in English that you like (and why).
 - A word or phrase in English that you find difficult to pronounce.

Present :

- You will have 60 seconds to share this information with your classmates.
- Make it fun and keep it engaging!

Engage:

- After each presentation, feel free to ask follow-up questions to get to know your classmates better.



Lektor

What's your communication style?

hesitant cautious
careful
open-minded efficient
spontaneous
realistic
practical adventurous
solution-oriented
bold



What's your communication style in English?

hesitant cautious
careful
open-minded efficient
spontaneous
realistic
practical adventurous
solution-oriented
bold



Quiz

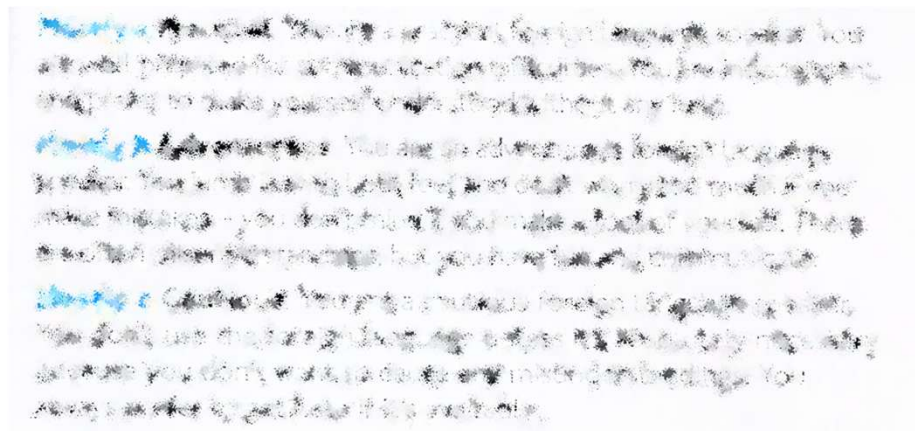
You're travelling abroad and you're in a country where you only speak a little of the language. What do you do in the situations below?

- 1** You are doing some shopping in a greengrocer's. You want to buy a vegetable, but you don't know the word for it. What do you do?
 - a Draw a picture of it or look it up in the dictionary.
 - b Try to make yourself understood using other words and gestures.
 - c Buy something that you know the word for instead.
- 2** Someone says something you don't understand. What do you do?
 - a Ask them to repeat it more slowly and make an effort to understand.
 - b Make an educated guess about what they said and respond to that.
 - c Tell them that you're foreign and don't understand.
- 3** You need to get your residence permit renewed, and you are supposed to phone to make an appointment. What do you do?
 - a Study some useful words and phrases before you pick up the phone.
 - b Go along in person and try to make yourself understood in any way you can.
 - c Ask a native speaker to make the phone call for you to make sure nothing goes wrong.
- 4** Someone asks you where a place is. You know the place and it isn't far away, but it's difficult to explain in the local language. What do you do?
 - a Point them in the right direction and tell them to ask again later.
 - b Offer to take them there and try to chat and make friends on the way. You'll be doing them a favour and practising at the same time!
 - c Make an excuse and advise them to ask someone else. If you try to explain, you'll probably do more harm than good. You don't want them to get lost!
- 5** You are at a hotel reception and you want to know whether the rooms have an Internet connection so that you can do some work. What do you do?
 - a You try to memorize the correct question from your phrasebook to ask if the rooms have an Internet connection.
 - b You know that the receptionist speaks your language better than you speak hers, but you try to make your enquiry in the local language anyway – you need to practise!
 - c You're afraid to make a fool of yourself so you ask to speak to someone who speaks your language.
- 6** Some locals invite you to join them on a picnic. What do you do?
 - a Accept but explain that you may have to leave early because you've made arrangements to meet somebody later. If communication becomes too difficult, you'll have a good excuse to leave.
 - b Accept and take the opportunity to practise the language.
 - c Ask if any of the people who are going speak your language. If so, you spend most of your time talking with them.



Results

Count how many times you answered **a**, **b**, or **c** in the quiz. Which letter did you choose most often?
Check the interpretation of results. Do you agree with your results? Explain why/why not.



<https://wordwall.net/play/96938/242/658>



Lektor

Bonus

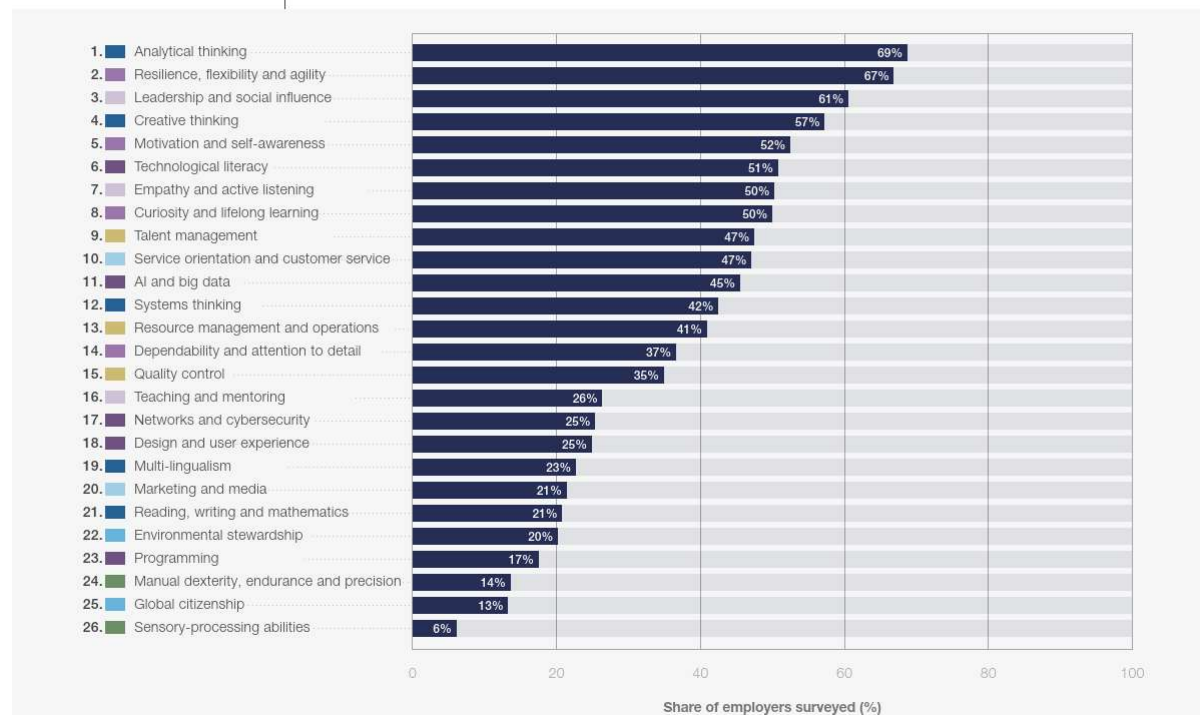


Lektor

Syllabus negotiation

FIGURE 3.3 Core skills in 2025

Share of employers who consider the stated skills to be core skills for their workforce.



Lektor

Course topics

1. Introductions 

2. Analytical thinking

3. Resilience, flexibility and agility

4. Leadership and social influence

5. Creative thinking

6. Motivation and self-awareness

7. Empathy and active listening

8. Curiosity and lifelong learning

9. Teaching and mentoring

10. Working with others

11. Communication

12. Fun with language



Lektor

That's all, folks!

